Wycliffe Associates

Bible Translation Reviewers' Guide

Romans

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1:1-7

Background: Throughout this letter to the Romans, Paul talked about we, us, and you. Although what Paul said in this letter can apply to all Christians, here Paul was usually talking about himself and the Roman Christians. In this passage, Paul mentions David. David was a king of Israel who lived long before Paul wrote this letter.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul was called to be an apostle. He was set apart for the gospel. [1:1]
- ☐ The gospel about the Son of God was promised long ago. [1:2-3]
- ☐ Jesus Christ was shown to be the Son of God. [1:4]
- ☐ Paul was an apostle through Jesus' grace, so he could call many people to obey God through faith. [1:5]
- ☐ Paul was writing this letter to believers in Rome. [1:7]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [1:1] How did Paul describe himself?
   Paul was a servant of Jesus Christ. He was called to be an apostle. He was set apart for the gospel of God.

2. [1:2] Through what people had God promised the gospel before Paul's time?
   God had promised the gospel before by his prophets in the scriptures.

3. [1:1-3] Who is the gospel about?
   The gospel is about the Son of God.

4. [1:3] Whose descendant was God's Son, according to his physical nature or flesh?
   He was a descendant of David.

5. [1:4] What did Jesus' resurrection from the dead declare (or show) about him?
   It showed that he is the Son of God.

6. [1:4] Who is the Son of God?
   Jesus Christ our Lord.

7. [1:5] For what purpose did Paul receive grace and apostleship from Christ?
   Paul received grace and apostleship so that he could call people from among all nations to obey God by faith.

8. [1:6] What were the recipients of this letter called to do?
   They were called to belong to Jesus Christ.

Romans 1:1-7 continued

9. [1:7] To what people was the letter to the Romans written?
   The letter was written to all those in Rome who were loved by God and called to be God's holy people.

10. [1:7] What blessing did Paul give to the Roman Christians?
    Paul blessed them with grace and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

Comment Section:

2:12-16

Background: Long ago, God had given his law to the Jewish people. The Gentiles did not have the law. Some Jewish people thought that they were righteous because they had the law. Earlier in chapter 2, Paul rebuked people who judged others even though they did the same things as those that they judged.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ All who sin apart from the law will perish apart from the law. All who sin under the law will be judged by the law. [2:12]

☐ Hearing the law will not make someone righteous. Only obeying the law justifies a person. [2:13]

☐ When Gentiles did what was in the law, they showed that the law was written on their hearts. [2:14-15]

☐ God will judge the secrets of all people. [2:16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [2:12] What happens to people who do not have the law and who sin?
   They will perish without the law.

2. [2:12] What happens to people who have the law and who sin against it?
   They will be judged by the law.

3. [2:13] Who will not be righteous before God?
   Those who only hear the law will not be righteous before God.

4. [2:13] Who will be justified before God?
   Those who obey the law will be justified.

5. [2:14] When Gentiles did by nature the things required by the law, what was true about them?
   They were a law to themselves.

6. [2:14] What do you think it means for people to do by nature something required by the law?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps it means that people might do what is right because they know it is right by instinct, even though they have never heard the law that told them what they must do.

7. [2:15] What did Paul say about the consciences of the Gentiles who did not have the law?
   Their consciences bore witness that actions required by the law were written in their hearts.

8. [2:15] How did their consciences show that those requirements were written in their hearts?
   Their thoughts either accused them or defended them.

Romans 2:12-16 continued

9. [2:15] What do you think it means that these people's thoughts accused or defended them?
   This seems to mean that these people knew if they had done right or wrong, even though they had not heard the law.

10. [2:16] What will God judge?
    God will judge the secret thoughts of all people.

Comment Section:

3:9-26

Background: In this section, Paul referred to Jews and Greeks. Often in the New Testament, the word “Greeks” was used to refer to Gentiles—that is, to all people who were not Jews.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Both Jews and Greeks were under sin. [3:9]
- ☐ The scriptures say that no one is righteous. [3:10]
- ☐ The scriptures tell how very sinful people are: No one seeks God. Not even one person does good. [3:11-12]
- ☐ All speak what is evil and do what is evil. [3:13-18]
- ☐ No one will be justified by the law. Instead, the law reveals sin. [3:20]
- ☐ There is a righteousness through faith in Jesus Christ for all who believe. [3:21-22]
- ☐ All have sinned. All are justified by God’s grace and Jesus’ redemption. [3:23-24]
- ☐ God gave Christ as a sacrifice, to be received by faith. This showed God’s righteousness. [3:25-26]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [3:9] Who did Paul describe as under sin?
   He described both Jews and Greeks as under sin.

2. [3:9] How many people do you think this means are under sin?
   Because anyone who is not a Jew was called a Greek in this passage, this means that all people are under sin.

3. [3:9] What do you think it means to be under sin?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps it means to be controlled by sin, or to be an enemy of God and separated from him.

4. [3:10-11] What did Paul say was written concerning who is righteous?
   Paul said that it was written that no one is righteous. No one understands and no one seeks God.

5. [3:13] How are people's throats and mouths described?
   People’s throats are like open graves. Their tongues do not tell the truth. It is like snake poison is on their lips.

6. [3:15] What are people’s feet quick to do?
   Their feet are quick to shed blood.

7. [3:15] What do you think that this means?
   (Answer may vary.) This seems to mean that people are quick to hurt and kill other people.

Romans 3:9-26 continued

8. [3:19] Who did the law speak to?
   It spoke to those who were under the law.

9. [3:19] In what way do you think mouths will be shut?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps because the law (the scriptures that Paul just quoted) says that no one is righteous, no one would be able to say, "I am righteous."

10. [3:20] Who can be justified by the works of the law?
    No people can be justified by the works of the law.

11. [3:20] What came through the law?
    The knowledge of sin came through the law.

12. [3:21] What did the Law and the Prophets testify to?
    They testified to the righteousness of God.

13. [3:22] How does the righteousness of God come to people?
    It comes through faith in Christ Jesus to all who believe.

14. [3:23] What did Paul say about all people in verse 23?
    All people have sinned and do not fulfill the standard set by God's glory.

15. [3:24] Since all people sin, how can anyone be justified?
    People can be freely justified by God's grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus.

16. [3:24] What do you think it means for a person to be freely justified by God's grace?
    This and other passages indicate that a person can be regarded by God as righteous without earning that righteousness. In other words, a person can be made right with God, and no longer guilty of sin, as a free gift through God's grace.

17. [3:24] What do you think that it means to have redemption through Christ?
    This and other passages show that it means that Christ paid the price to set people free from their bondage to sin.

18. [3:25] What did God do so that people could have redemption, or be redeemed?
    God provided Christ Jesus to be an atoning sacrifice that people can receive through faith in his blood.

19. [3:25] What do you think it means that Christ was an atoning sacrifice?
    This and other passages show that it means that Christ died as a sin offering to meet God's demand for justice for people's sins.

20. [3:25-26] Why had God disregarded previous sins?
    God did this because he is patient.

21. [3:26] Who does God justify?
    He justifies anyone who has faith in Jesus.

Comment Section:

5:6-15

Background: In this section Paul mentioned Adam and Moses. The Old Testament book of Genesis told about them. Adam was the first person that God created. Adam was the first man to sin against God. Moses lived many years after Adam. He was a prophet, and God gave the law through Moses.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ God showed his love for people in that while they were still sinners, Christ died for them. [5:8]
- ☐ People were made righteous by Christ's death on the cross. They are saved by him from God's wrath. [5:9]
- ☐ While people were God's enemies, they were reconciled to God by the death of his Son. They will be saved by Christ's life. [5:10]
- ☐ Sin came into the world through Adam, and sin led to death for all. [5:12]
- ☐ Because of Adam's sin many people died, but God's grace and Christ's gift overflowed even more to many people. [5:15]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [5:6] Who did Christ die for?
   He died for ungodly people.

2. [5:7] For what kind of a person might someone perhaps dare to die?
   Someone might dare to die for a good person.

3. [5:8] How did God prove his love for people?
   Christ died for people while they were still sinners.

4. [5:9] How are people made righteous. or justified?
   People are made righteous by Christ's blood and his death on the cross.

5. [5:9] What will Christ save believers from?
   He will save them from God's wrath.

6. [5:10] While people were God's enemies, what did he do for them?
   God reconciled them to himself through his Son's death.

7. [5:10] What will happen to people who have been reconciled to God by Christ's death?
   They will be saved by Christ's life.

8. [5:11] How do people change who have been reconciled to God?
   They rejoice in God through the Lord Jesus Christ.

Romans 5:6-15 continued

9. [5:12] How did sin enter into the world?
   Sin entered the world through one man.

10. [5:12] What do you think it means that sin entered the world through one man?
    (Answer may vary.) This seems to mean that sin first came into the world when Adam, who was the first man in the world, sinned for the first time.

11. [5:12] How did death spread to all people?
    Death spread to all people because they all sinned.

12. [5:13] In verse 13, how was the time before the law described?
    Sin was in the world, but there was no accounting for sin without the law.

13. [5:14] From the time of Adam to Moses, what people did death reign over?
    It reigned over all people, even those who did not sin in the same way that Adam did.

14. [5:14] Why do you think death reigned even over people who did not sin in the same way that Adam did?
    The text indicates that those people also sinned, even though they did not disobey the same command as Adam disobeyed.

15. [5:15] How was God's gift different from Adam's sin?
    Adam’s sin caused many to die, but the gift of Jesus Christ overflowed to many.

16. [5:15] How did that gift come?
    It came by the grace of the one man, Jesus Christ.

Comment Section:

6:8-14

Background: Earlier in this chapter, Paul explained that people who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death. They were united with Christ in a death like his.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Those who have died with Christ will live together with him. [6:8]
- ☐ Christ died to sin and lives to God. [6:10]
- ☐ Christians should consider themselves dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus. [6:11]
- ☐ Christians must not let sin rule in their bodies. [6:12]
- ☐ Christians are not under law but under grace. [6:14]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [6:8] If people have died with Christ, what else will they do?
   They will also live together with Christ.

2. [6:9] What did Paul say about Christ in verse 9?
   Christ has been raised from the dead, so he cannot die again.

3. [6:10] How many times did Christ die to sin?
   Christ died to sin just once.

4. [6:10] What do you think this means?
   This indicates that the work is done. Jesus will never have to die to sin again.

5. [6:10] Who does Christ live to?
   He lives to God.

6. [6:11] How should a believer think of himself with regard to sin?
   A believer should think of himself as dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus.

7. [6:12] So, if a person is dead to sin, how should he live?
   He should not let sin rule in his body so that he does not obey its strong desires.

8. [6:13] What do you think it means that a believer should not offer himself to sin but rather should offer himself to God?
   (Answer may vary.) It probably means that a believer should present every part of himself to God, for doing God's good will.

Romans 6:8-14 continued

9. Why should believers not let sin rule over them? [6:14]
   They should not let sin rule over them because believers are not under law, but under grace.

Comment Section:

7:21-25

Background: In the passage before this one, Paul wrote about wanting to do what is good but instead doing evil. This passage continues Paul's thoughts about this.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul wrote that he wanted to do good. [7:21-22]
- ☐ But the law of sin in his body fought against the law of God in his mind. [7:23]
- ☐ Paul asked who would rescue him from this body of death. [7:24]
- ☐ Paul thanked God through Jesus Christ. [7:25]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [7:21] What law, or principle, did Paul find at work in him?
   Paul found that when he wanted to do good, evil was present with him.

2. [7:22] What attitude did Paul's inner man have toward the law of God?
   Paul's inner man rejoiced in the law of God.

3. [7:23] What law, or principle, did Paul find working in his mind and body?
   Paul found another law, or principle, that made him captive to the law of sin.

4. [7:24] What did Paul want someone to do for him?
   He wanted someone to deliver him from his body of death.

5. [7:25] What do you think Paul meant when he thanked God in verse 25?
   Paul probably thanked God because he knew that God would rescue him through Jesus Christ.

6. [7:25] What was the difference between Paul's mind and Paul's flesh?
   With his mind, Paul served the law of God. But with his flesh, Paul served the law of sin.

7. [7:25] What do you think it meant that Paul served the law of God with his mind but that he served the law of sin with his flesh?
   This probably means that Paul wanted to obey the law of God, but he would still do some things that were wrong.

Comment Section:

8:9-17

Background: This passage mentions that believers can call God the Father "Abba." In the language that Jesus spoke, this word was used for "father" by a beloved child. Jesus used this word when speaking to God, his Father.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ If anyone has the Spirit of Christ, his body is dead because of sin, but his spirit is alive because of righteousness. [8:10]
- ☐ If anyone has the Spirit of him who raised Jesus from the dead, he who raised Jesus will give life to his mortal body. [8:11]
- ☐ Christians were not to live according to the flesh. [8:12-13]
- ☐ Those who were led by the Spirit of God were sons of God and heirs of God. [8:14-17]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [8:9] Why would the Roman believers not be in the flesh's control, but in the Spirit's control?
   This is because believers who have the Spirit of God living in them are in the Spirit's control.

2. [8:9] What did Paul say was true of anyone who does not have the Spirit of Christ?
   That person does not belong to Christ.

3. [8:10] If Christ is in a person, what is true about that person's body and spirit?
   Although the body is dead because of sin, the spirit is alive because of righteousness.

4. [8:10] What do you think it means that the body is dead because of sin, but the spirit is alive because of righteousness?
   This probably means that each person's body will die because of sin, or that each person's body has been controlled by death because of sin. It probably means that the spirit of the person is alive, and that the Spirit gives that person life, because of Christ's righteousness.

5. [8:11] Paul mentioned the Spirit of him who raised Jesus from the dead. Who do you think raised Jesus from the dead?
   This passage and other passages make it clear that God the Father raised Jesus from the dead.

6. [8:11] What will God do for people if his Spirit lives in them?
   God will give their bodies life through his Spirit.

7. [8:12] What are Christians not obligated to?
   Christians are not obligated to the flesh. They are not obligated to live according to fleshly desires.

Romans 8:9-17 continued

8. [8:13] What will happen to people if they live according to the flesh?
   They will die.

9. [8:13] What will happen to people if they put to death the deeds of the body?
   They will live.

10. [8:14] Who are children of God?
    All who are led by the Spirit of God are God's children.

11. [8:15] What Spirit do the children of God receive?
    They receive the Spirit of adoption.

12. [8:15] What do God's children have the privilege of calling God?
    God's children may call him "Abba, Father."

13. [8:16] What does the Spirit do for the children of God?
    He bears witness with our spirit that we are children of God.

14. [8:17] As children of God, what other benefits do believers receive in God's family?
    As children of God, believers are also heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ.

15. [8:17] How can a person be a joint heir with Christ?
    He must suffer with Christ in order to be glorified with Christ.

Comment Section:

9:30-33

Background: In this section Paul quoted two passages from the Old Testament book of Isaiah, which was written by the prophet Isaiah.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ The Gentiles, who were not pursuing righteousness, attained it by faith. [9:30]

☐ Israel, who pursued a law of righteousness by works of the law and not by faith, did not attain it. [9:31-32]

☐ Israel stumbled over a stone of stumbling and a rock of offense. [9:33]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [9:30] How did the Gentiles, who were not pursuing righteousness, gain it?
   The Gentiles gained it by faith.

2. [9:31] What did the people of Israel pursue?
   They pursued the law in order to become righteous.

3. [9:32] Why did the law not make them righteous?
   The law did not make them righteous because they pursued it by works and not by faith.

4. [9:32] Over what did the Israelites stumble?
   The Israelites stumbled over the stumbling stone.

5. [9:33] When Paul writes about the stone of stumbling and the rock of offense, what do you think he means?
   (Answer may vary.) From this verse, it seems clear that Jesus Christ is called the stone of stumbling, because those who believe in Jesus will not be ashamed. (See also Romans 10:9-11.) The rock of offense has a similar meaning. So this would mean that Jesus Christ was seen as an obstacle and an offense to the Israelites who wanted righteousness by works and not by faith.

6. [9:33] What happens to those who believe in the one called the stone of stumbling?
   Those who believe in the one called the stone of stumbling will not be ashamed.

Comment Section:

10:9-15

Background: In this section, Paul referred to being a Jew or a Greek. Often in the New Testament, the word “Greek” was used to refer to Gentiles—that is, to all people who were not Jews.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ If a person confesses that Jesus is Lord and believes that God raised him from the dead, he will be saved. [10:9-10]
- ☐ No one who believes in him will be ashamed. [10:11]
- ☐ Everyone who believes and calls on the Lord will be saved. This is the same whether a person is a Jew or a Greek. [10:12-13]
- ☐ In order for people to call on the name of the Lord, they first need to hear about the Lord. [10:14-15]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [10:9] How did Paul say a person is saved?
   A person is saved if he confesses with his mouth that Jesus is Lord and believes in his heart that God raised Jesus from the dead.

2. [10:9-10] How does a person become righteous?
   A person becomes righteous by believing in Christ.

3. [10:11] What does the scripture say about the one who believes in Jesus Christ?
   People who believe in him will not be ashamed.

4. [10:12] Is there a distinction made between Jew and Greek? Why or why not?
   No, there is no distinction between Jew and Greek, because Jesus is the Lord of all, and he is generous to all who call on him.

5. [10:13] According to verse 13, what must a person do to be saved?
   A person must call upon the name of the Lord.

6. [10:13] What do you think it means to call on the name of the Lord?
   (Answer may vary.) Here, it seems to mean acknowledging Jesus as the Lord, or perhaps asking the Lord for forgiveness and salvation.

7. [10:14] In verse 14, what does the first question say needs to happen for people to be able to call on the name of the Lord?
   They first need to believe in the Lord.

Romans 10:9-15 continued

8. [10:14] In verse 14, what does the second question say needs to happen for people to believe in the Lord?
   They first need to hear about the Lord.

9. [10:14] In verse 14, what does the third question say needs to happen for people to hear about the Lord?
   A preacher needs to go to them and preach about the Lord.

10. [10:15] What needs to happen in order for preachers to preach to them?
    They need to be sent.

11. [10:15] Paul quoted a sentence from the Old Testament. What did this sentence say?
    It said that the feet of those who preach good news are beautiful.

12. [10:15] Why do you think someone might say the Old Testament words in verse 15?
    (Answer may vary.) Perhaps they would say that because they were very happy that someone came to tell them the good news. Or maybe this describes the way God views his messengers.

Comment Section:

11:17-23

Background: Paul had written that many Jews did not believe the gospel, and because of that he preached to the Gentiles. But Paul was confident that God had chosen some Jews who would believe the gospel.

In this passage, Paul uses an olive tree as an analogy, or a word picture. An olive farmer can cut a branch from one olive tree and connect it to, or graft it into, the main root stem of another olive tree. Then the branch will grow as if it had been one of that tree's regular branches. The olive tree root in this passage represents being united to God as part of his family. The natural branches represent the Jews. The wild branches represent those who are not Jews.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Some of the natural olive tree branches were broken off. The Roman believers who received this letter were like a wild branch that was grafted into the olive tree root. [11:17]
- ☐ Paul warned them not to boast as if they were better than the natural branches that were broken off. [11:18]
- ☐ He warned them to remember that they were a branch supported by the root. [11:18]
- ☐ Those in the wild branch might say that natural branches were removed so that wild branches could join the tree. [11:19]
- ☐ The natural branches were broken off because of unbelief. [11:20]
- ☐ Wild branches also could be broken off, if they fell into unbelief. [11:21-22]
- ☐ If the natural branches did not continue in unbelief, God could graft them back in. [11:23]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [11:17] What happened to the olive tree in Paul's analogy, or word picture?
   Some of its branches were broken off, and a wild olive branch was grafted into the tree.

2. [11:17] What did Paul say about the Roman believers who received this letter?
   They were a wild olive branch that was grafted into the olive tree root and shared in its rich nourishment.

3. [11:18] What did Paul tell those who were part of the wild olive branch not to do?
   He told them not to boast as if they were better than the branches that were broken off.

4. [11:18] Why should the wild olive branches not boast?
   They should not boast because they did not support the root, but the root supported them.

5. [11:19] What might those who were part of the wild olive branch say?
   They might say that branches were broken off so that they could be grafted in.

Romans 11:17-23 continued

6. [11:20] Why were the natural branches broken off from the olive tree?
   This happened because they did not believe.

7. [11:21] What warning did Paul give to those in the wild branch?
   Paul warned those in the wild branch that if God did not spare the natural branches, neither would he spare the wild branch if they fell into unbelief.

8. [11:22] Who was God severe toward?
   He was severe toward the Jews who fell.

9. [11:22] Who do you think were the branches that were cut off?
   The passage indicates that they were the Jews who did not believe the gospel.

10. [11:22] What did the wild branches need to do?
    They needed to continue in God's kindness.

11. [11:23] What would God do with natural branches if they did not continue in their unbelief?
    God would graft them back into the tree.

Comment Section:

12:1-8

Background: In chapters 1-11, Paul taught all that God had done to save people from their sins. In this passage, Paul starts teaching believers how they should live.

In the Old Testament, God had commanded his people to kill animals and offer the dead animals to him as sacrifices. In contrast, this passage speaks about people offering God a living sacrifice of their own bodies.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul urged the believers to offer their bodies as living sacrifices to God. [12:1]
- ☐ Believers should be conformed to the will of God, not conformed to the world. [12:2]
- ☐ Believers must not think of themselves more highly than they ought. [12:3]
- ☐ Paul compared the body of Christ to the human body, to demonstrate how different parts of the body are responsible for different functions, while all being part of the same body. [12:4-6]
- ☐ Believers must exercise their gifts according to the amount of their faith. [12:6]
- ☐ Paul listed several different kinds of gifts that believers might have. He said that all believers must use these gifts. [12:7-8]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [12:1] What is the believers' spiritual service to God?
   The believers' spiritual service is to present their bodies as a holy, acceptable, living sacrifice to God.

2. [12:1] What do you think it means for believers to present their bodies as a living sacrifice?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps it means that believers should use their whole bodies or their whole selves to serve God. Perhaps it means that believers should use their bodies in ways that God would see as holy and acceptable.

3. [12:2] What do you think Paul meant when he said that believers should not be conformed to the world?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps, if believers are conformed to the world, this means that they will act like the people of the world who do not believe in God. People who do not believe in God do not live as God wants them to live, so this would not be the way that believers would want to be.

4. [12:2] What does a transformed mind enable the believer to do?
   A transformed mind enables a believer to know the good, acceptable, and perfect will of God.

5. [12:3] How must believers think of themselves?
   Believers must think of themselves with sober judgment, according to the amount of faith God has given to them.

6. [12:4] How do the parts of a human body differ from each other?
   They have different functions. They do different things.

Romans 12:1-8 continued

7. [12:5] How are the many believers related to each other in Christ?
   The many believers are one body in Christ. Individually, they are members of each other.

8. [12:4-6] How do you think that Paul meant for the members of Christ's body to be compared to the parts of a human body?
   Paul indicates that just as the parts of a body have different functions that benefit the whole body, members of Christ's body have different gifts that benefit the whole body of Christ, or the Church.

9. [12:6-8] What are the gifts that Paul mentioned in verses 6, 7, and 8?
   Paul mentioned prophecy, serving, teaching, encouragement, giving, leading, and mercy.

10. [12:6-8] Who do you think gives these gifts to believers?
    From this and other passages, it is clear that God, by his grace, gives these gifts to believers.

11. [12:6-8] What should believers do with the gifts that God gives to them?
    Believers should use the gifts that God has given to them according to the amount or proportion of their faith.

Comment Section:

13:8-10

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Paul said that believers should owe only love to others. [13:8]

☐ A believer who loves his neighbor has fulfilled the law. [13:8, 10]

☐ All the commandments are summed up by love for neighbors. [13:9]

☐ Love does no wrong to a neighbor. [13:10]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [13:8] What is the one thing that Paul said believers owe to others?
   Paul said that believers owe love to others.

2. [13:8] What do you think Paul meant when he said to owe nothing to anyone except to love one another?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps he meant that people must pay what they owe, and believers must not remain in debt. Or perhaps he meant that believers should avoid debt to others. But he certainly meant that believers must always love one another.

3. [13:8] How does a believer fulfill the law?
   A believer fulfills the law by loving others.

4. [13:9] Which commandments did Paul list as part of the law?
   Paul listed the following commands:
   - Do not commit adultery.
   - Do not murder.
   - Do not steal.
   - Do not covet.

5. [13:9] What commandment sums up the other commandments?
   Love your neighbor as yourself.

6. [13:9-10] How do you think love fulfills the law?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps if people love others, they will not need to be concerned about the law. Someone who loves a neighbor will not commit adultery, murder, steal, covet, or do other things that harm that neighbor.

Comment Section:

14:13-19

Background: Long ago, God told the people of Israel not to eat the meat of certain animals. He called those animals unclean. He also told the people of Israel to celebrate certain days. God gave these laws to his own people. The Gentiles did not have those laws.

In the passage before this one, Paul instructed believers not to despise or judge one another concerning whether or not they ate certain foods or whether or not they honored certain days. God accepts all believers, regardless of what they eat. In the end, God will be the one to judge everyone.

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul said that they should not pass judgment on others, and they should never put a stumbling block in the way of a brother. [14:13]
- ☐ Paul said that he knew that nothing is unclean in itself. But if a person considers a thing unclean, that thing is unclean for that person. [14:14]
- ☐ If another believer is grieved by what you eat, you are not walking in love. [14:15]
- ☐ The kingdom of God is about righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit. [14:17]
- ☐ Whoever serves God in this way is acceptable to God and to man. [14:18]
- ☐ Believers should pursue things that lead to peace and to building up each other. [14:19]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [14:13] What should believers stop doing?
   Believers should stop judging one another.

2. [14:13] What should believers do instead?
   Believers should decide not to put a stumbling block or snare in front of another believer.

3. [14:13] What do you think it means for a believer to put a stumbling block or snare in front of another believer?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps this means that a believer does something that causes another believer to sin.

4. [14:14] According to Paul, what foods are unclean?
   Paul said that he knew and was persuaded in the Lord Jesus that no foods are unclean.

5. [14:14] For what person is a particular food unclean?
   A particular food is unclean only for the person who considers it to be unclean.

6. [14:15] If a brother or sister is hurt because of what a believer eats, what does that show about the believer?
   It shows that the believer is not acting in a loving way.

Romans 14:13-18 continued

7. [14:15] How do you think believers could offend someone else with their food?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps if a believer encourages a brother in Christ to eat a food that the brother thinks is sinful, then the brother might eat that food and sin by doing what he thinks is sinful.

8. [14:16] What did Paul warn believers not to do in verse 16?
   He warned them not to let what they consider good to be spoken of as evil.

9. [14:16] If Christians believe that God allows them to eat a certain food, how do you think they can keep others from calling it evil?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps believers can avoid eating that food in front of people who believe that God does not allow it. Believers can also probably work to avoid arguing about which foods God allows them to eat.

10. [14:17] What does Paul say that the kingdom of God is not about?
    The kingdom of God is not about eating and drinking.

11. [14:17] What does Paul say the kingdom of God is about?
    The kingdom of God is about righteousness, peace, and joy in the Holy Spirit.

12. [14:18] How do God and other people view a person who serves Christ in this way?
    A person who serves Christ in this way is acceptable to God and approved by other people.

13. [14:19] What did Paul encourage the believers to pursue?
    He encouraged them to pursue things that promote peace and to pursue things that build others up.

Comment Section:

15:14-16

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

☐ Paul expressed confidence in the Roman believers who received this letter. [15:14]

☐ He said that he had written boldly in this letter to remind them of some things. [15:15]

☐ Paul had done this because God had made him a servant of Christ Jesus to the Gentiles. [15:16]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [15:14] What was Paul convinced about concerning the believers in Rome?
   He was convinced that they were full of goodness and knowledge and that they were able to instruct one another.

2. [15:15] Why did Paul write boldly about some points in his letter?
   Paul wrote boldly about these as reminders to the believers.

3. [15:15-16] What role did God, in his grace, give to Paul?
   God made Paul a servant of Christ Jesus sent to the Gentiles.

4. [15:16] What was Paul's purpose as a servant of Christ Jesus?
   Paul's purpose was to offer the gospel of God as a priest, so that the offering of the Gentiles might become acceptable, sanctified by the Holy Spirit.

5. [15:16] What do you think Paul meant by the offering of the Gentiles in this way?
   (Answer may vary.) Perhaps Paul meant to refer to the offerings brought to God by priests in the Old Testament. When Paul preached the gospel and the Gentiles obeyed Christ, perhaps they were like an offering that Paul presented to God.

Comment Section:

16:17-19

Read the passage.

Part 1

Tell in your own words what you just read in this passage.

- ☐ Paul warned the church in Rome to avoid people who caused divisions. [16:17]
- ☐ Paul said that those who caused divisions deceived people through smooth talk and flattery. [16:18]
- ☐ Paul said that everyone knew about the Roman believers' obedience. [16:19]
- ☐ He wanted the believers to hold on to what was good but to reject what was evil. [16:19]

Part 2

Answer the following questions from the specified verses.

1. [16:17] What warning did Paul give to the believers?
   Paul warned them to beware of people who caused divisions and who created obstacles that were contrary to what they had been taught. Paul said they should avoid these people.

2. [16:18] Who or what did those people serve?
   Paul said that these people served their own stomachs.

3. [16:18] What do you think Paul meant when he said that they serve their stomach?
   (Answer may vary.) He may have meant that they had selfish motives for teaching things that caused divisions and stumbling. Or he may have meant that they taught so that they could receive food from the people they taught.

4. [16:18] How did those that caused divisions deceive others?
   They deceived others through smooth talk and flattery.

5. [16:19] Why did Paul rejoice over the Roman believers?
   He did this because everyone had heard about these believers' obedience.

6. [16:19] How did Paul tell the believers to think?
   He told them to be wise as to what was good and innocent as to what was evil.

Comment Section: